Concept	Your Description	Refined & Easy-to-Understand Definition	Key Distinction
Authentication	Check if person have the permission do specific things	Proving you are who you say you are. It's like showing your ID at a security desk.	vs. Authorization: Authentication is about identity. Authorization is about permissions. You authenticate first, then you are authorized.
Authorization	The right/permission to do a specific task is granted to an entity	The permissions you are given after you prove who you are. It's the list of rooms your keycard can open.	vs. Authentication: You can't be authorized until you've been authenticated.
Confidentiality	Data can only be accessed by persons with the right authorization	Keeping secrets secret. Ensuring that only the right people can see the information. Think of a sealed letter.	vs. Integrity: Confidentiality is about secrecy. Integrity is about the data not being changed or tampered with.
Integrity	Information is protected from being modified by unauthorized parties	Ensuring data is trustworthy and has not been changed. It's making sure the letter inside the sealed envelope hasn't been altered.	vs. Confidentiality: A file could be public (not confidential) but still require high integrity (like a software download you don't want infected with a virus).
Availability	Ensure information is always available to the end-user	Ensuring that systems and data are ready and accessible when authorized users need them. It's making sure the post office is open when you need to get your letter.	
Risk	A measure of events which an entity is threatened by a potential circumstance	The potential for loss when a threat exploits a vulnerability. Think of it as the realistic danger to your assets.	vs. Threat: A threat is a potential danger (like a hurricane). Risk is the likelihood the hurricane will hit your specific house and the impact it would have.
Threat	Circumstance or events that could cause harm to the system	Anything that could potentially harm an asset. It's the "what could go wrong?"	vs. Vulnerability: A threat is the actor or event (the burglar). A vulnerability is the weakness the threat exploits (the unlocked window).
Vulnerability	Weakness in an information system	A weakness or gap in security that can be exploited. It's the unlocked window a burglar could climb through.	vs. Threat: You can have a vulnerability (unlocked window) without a threat (no burglars in the area).
Encryption	Converting content to unreadable	Scrambling data using a secret key so that only authorized parties can read it. It's writing your letter in a secret code.	A primary technical control used to enforce the principle of confidentiality.
Administrative Cc	Gain people's president on policy and procedures	Security rules for people. These are policies, procedures, and training that direct human behavior. Example: A rule stating you must lock your computer when you leave your desk.	vs. Technical Control: An admin control is a rule for a person. A technical control is a setting in a machine (like the computer auto-locking after 5 minutes).